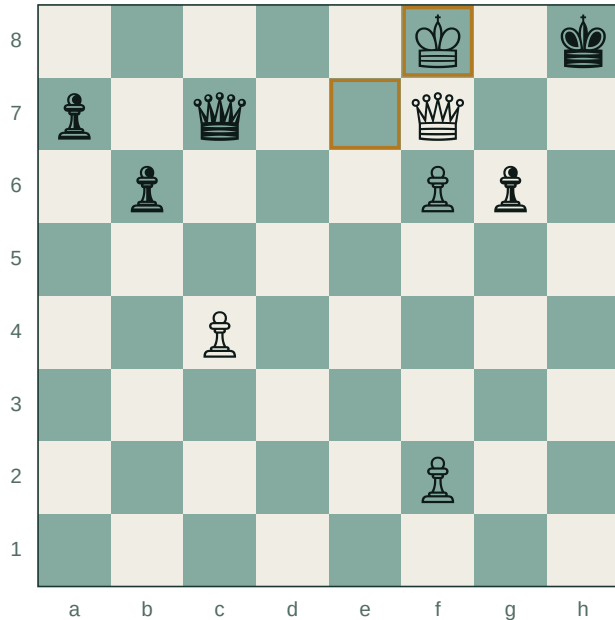


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 69

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 69.Kf8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

69...Qd8+ 70. Qe8 Qxf6+

69...Qd8+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **70.Qe8**.

70...Qxf6+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on f8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.